

FREE EDITION

TCS Smart Hiring Aptitude Tricks 2026-27

6 Powerful Shortcuts to Score 15+ Extra Marks
No Negative Marking | BCA / B.Sc / B.Voc

By Classic Technology | classicprofile.com

80

Total Questions

120

Minutes

0

Negative Marks

85%

Cutoff (Approx)

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EXAM PATTERN - TCS SMART HIRING 2026-27

Section	Questions	Time	Per Question	Difficulty
Numerical Ability	26	40 min	~1.5 min	Medium-Hard
Reasoning Ability	30	50 min	~1.6 min	Easy-Medium
Verbal Ability	24	30 min	~1.25 min	Easy-Medium
Coding (Optional)	1-2	20 min	Optional	For Ignite Only

KEY FACTS - Read Before Starting

NO negative marking - guess every question, never leave blank!

Platform: TCS iON (in-centre, proctored test)

On-screen calculator + rough paper available

Eligible: BCA, B.Sc, B.Voc (CS/IT) - Batch 2025 & 2026

Minimum 50% aggregate in 10th, 12th, and Graduation

Smart = no coding required | Ignite = coding mandatory (better role)

TRICK #1

NO NEGATIVE MARKING = ATTEMPT EVERYTHING

The Most Important Strategy That 90% Freshers Don't Use

THE MATH BEHIND GUESSING

4 options per question = 25% chance of correct answer

If you SKIP 15 questions = 0 marks guaranteed

If you GUESS 15 questions = ~3-4 correct = 3-4 FREE marks

After eliminating 2 wrong options = 50% chance = ~7-8 correct!

NEVER leave a question blank. There is literally ZERO downside.

Real Impact on Your Score:

Strategy	Questions Left	Expected Correct	Extra Marks
Skip All (Most students)	15 blank	0	+0
Random Guess (25%)	15 guessed	~4	+4 FREE
Smart Guess (eliminate 2)	15 guessed	~7	+7 FREE

ELIMINATION TECHNIQUE - Turn 25% into 50%+

Step 1: Read all 4 options quickly

Step 2: Remove obviously absurd/extreme values

Step 3: If a number question - check if answer is close to your estimate

Step 4: For verbal - grammar rules can eliminate 1-2 options easily

Step 5: Guess from remaining 2 options = 50% chance!

REMEMBER: 4 extra marks from smart guessing can be the difference between SELECTED and REJECTED. The cutoff is tight!

TRICK #2

PERCENTAGE SHORTCUTS - 10% Building Block Method

TCS asks 3-5 percentage questions. Solve each in 15-30 seconds instead of 2 minutes.

Percentage	How to Calculate	Example (of 600)
10%	Divide by 10	60
5%	Half of 10%	30
1%	Divide by 100	6
20%	10% x 2	120
25%	Divide by 4	150
15%	10% + 5%	90
33.33%	Divide by 3	200
50%	Divide by 2	300
75%	50% + 25%	450

SOLVED EXAMPLE 1: Find 37% of 600

SLOW METHOD: $37/100 \times 600$ = complex multiplication

FAST METHOD (10% Blocks):

10% of 600 = 60
 30% = 60×3 = 180
 5% = $60 / 2$ = 30
 2% = $60 / 5$ = 12
 7% = $30 + 12$ = 42
 37% = $180 + 42$ = 222

Time saved: ~30 seconds per question!

SOLVED EXAMPLE 2: Shirt costs Rs.800, 15% discount. Price?

10% of 800 = 80
 5% of 800 = 40
 15% discount = $80 + 40$ = 120
 Final price = $800 - 120$ = Rs.680

SOLVED EXAMPLE 3: Price increases 20% then decreases 20%. Net change?

COMMON MISTAKE: Students think net = 0% (WRONG!)

TRICK FORMULA: When same % increase & decrease:

$$\begin{aligned}\text{Net change} &= -(\text{percentage})^2 / 100 \\ &= -(20)^2 / 100 = -400/100 = -4\%\end{aligned}$$

ANSWER: 4% DECREASE (not zero!)

Verify: 100 → +20% → 120 → -20% → 96 → Net = -4%

Fraction-Percentage Table (MEMORIZE!):

Fraction	%	Fraction	%	Fraction	%
1/2	50%	1/6	16.67%	1/10	10%
1/3	33.33%	1/7	14.28%	1/11	9.09%
1/4	25%	1/8	12.5%	1/12	8.33%
1/5	20%	1/9	11.11%	2/3	66.67%

PRACTICE PROBLEMS (Try before checking answers)

Q1: Find 43% of 700

Q2: Price drops 30% from Rs.1200. New price?

Q3: A number increases by 10% then 10% again. Total % increase?

Q4: 40% of ? = 160

Q5: What % of 250 is 45?

Answers: Q1: 301 | Q2: Rs.840 | Q3: 21% | Q4: 400 | Q5: 18%

TRICK #3

TIME & WORK - The LCM Method

THE single biggest time-saver. Eliminates all fractions. TCS asks 2-4 questions.

THE LCM METHOD - 4 Simple Steps

Step 1: Take LCM of all given days = TOTAL WORK (in units)

Step 2: Each person's SPEED = Total Work / Their Days

Step 3: COMBINED speed = Add all individual speeds

Step 4: TIME together = Total Work / Combined Speed

That's it! NO fractions like $1/10 + 1/15$. Pure simple numbers!

SOLVED EXAMPLE 1: A does work in 10 days, B in 15 days. Together?

OLD METHOD (Fractions)	LCM METHOD (Fast!)
A's 1 day = $1/10$ B's 1 day = $1/15$ Together = $1/10 + 1/15$ = $(3+2)/30 = 5/30$ = $1/6$ Answer: 6 days Error prone! Fractions!	Total Work = $\text{LCM}(10,15) = 30$ A's speed = $30/10 = \mathbf{3 \text{ units/day}}$ B's speed = $30/15 = \mathbf{2 \text{ units/day}}$ Together = $3+2 = \mathbf{5 \text{ units/day}}$ Time = $30/5 = \mathbf{6 \text{ days}}$ Clean numbers! No fractions!

SOLVED EXAMPLE 2: A=6 days, B=8 days, C=12 days. Together?

Total Work = $\text{LCM}(6, 8, 12) = 24$ units

A's speed = $24/6 = 4$ units/day

B's speed = $24/8 = 3$ units/day

C's speed = $24/12 = 2$ units/day

Together = $4 + 3 + 2 = 9$ units/day

Time = $24/9 = 2$ days 16 hours (2 and $2/3$ days)

SOLVED EXAMPLE 3: A works 2 days alone, then B joins. A=10d, B=15d. Total?

Total Work = LCM(10, 15) = 30 units
 A's speed = 3 units/day | B's speed = 2 units/day
 A alone for 2 days = $3 \times 2 = 6$ units done
 Remaining = $30 - 6 = 24$ units
 A+B together = $3 + 2 = 5$ units/day
 Time for remaining = $24/5 = 4.8$ days
 TOTAL = $2 + 4.8 = 6.8$ days

SOLVED EXAMPLE 4: PIPES & CISTERNS (Same concept!)

Pipe A fills in 12 hrs, Pipe B fills in 18 hrs, Pipe C EMPTIES in 36 hrs.
 All three open. How long to fill?

Total capacity = LCM(12, 18, 36) = 36 units
 A fills = $36/12 = +3$ units/hr
 B fills = $36/18 = +2$ units/hr
 C empties = $36/36 = -1$ unit/hr (NEGATIVE!)
 Net = $3 + 2 - 1 = 4$ units/hr
 Time = $36/4 = 9$ hours

Quick LCM Reference:

Numbers	LCM	Numbers	LCM
2, 3	6	10, 15	30
3, 4	12	12, 18	36
4, 6	12	15, 20	60
6, 8	24	6, 8, 12	24
8, 12	24	10, 15, 20	60

PRACTICE PROBLEMS

- Q1: A=20 days, B=30 days. Together?
 Q2: A=15d, B=20d. A works 5 days alone, B joins. Total?
 Q3: A+B together=6 days, B alone=10 days. A alone?
 Q4: Pipe fills in 20 hrs, Pipe empties in 30 hrs. Both open, fill time?
 Q5: A is 3x efficient as B. Together=9 days. B alone?

Answers: Q1: 12 days | Q2: 11 days | Q3: 15 days | Q4: 60 hours | Q5: 36 days

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Speed-Distance Train Problems | Profit-Loss Chains | Probability Shortcuts

Direction Sense Shadow Trick | 15 Grammar Rules | 25 Preposition Pairs

200+ Practice Problems with Solutions | Printable Formula Cheat Sheet

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TRICK #4

NUMBER SERIES - Difference Method

TCS asks 3-5 series questions. This method cracks 90% of them instantly.

THE METHOD - 3 Levels of Differences

- Step 1: Write differences between consecutive terms (Level 1)
- Step 2: If Level 1 is constant -> Add same constant. Done!
- Step 3: If not constant -> Find differences of differences (Level 2)
- Step 4: If Level 2 is constant -> pattern found!
- Step 5: If still not -> check for multiplication, squares, cubes

EXAMPLE 1: 3, 7, 11, 15, 19, ?

Level 1 differences: 4, 4, 4, 4 -> CONSTANT!
Next term = $19 + 4 = 23$

EXAMPLE 2: 2, 5, 10, 17, 26, ?

Level 1: 3, 5, 7, 9 (not constant)
Level 2: 2, 2, 2 -> CONSTANT!
Next L1 difference = $9 + 2 = 11$
Next term = $26 + 11 = 37$

EXAMPLE 3: 2, 6, 18, 54, 162, ?

Each term $\times 3$ = next (multiplication pattern)
 $162 \times 3 = 486$

EXAMPLE 4: 1, 2, 4, 8, 7, 32, 10, ? (Tricky!)

Two interleaved series!
Odd positions: 1, 4, 7, 10 -> +3 pattern
Even positions: 2, 8, 32, ? -> $\times 4$ pattern
Next even = $32 \times 4 = 128$

Pattern Cheat Sheet:

Pattern	Example	Rule
+constant	3, 7, 11, 15	Add same number

Pattern	Example	Rule
x constant	2, 6, 18, 54	Multiply same number
+increasing	2, 3, 5, 8, 12	+1, +2, +3, +4
Squares	1, 4, 9, 16, 25	n squared
Cubes	1, 8, 27, 64	n cubed
Fibonacci	1, 1, 2, 3, 5, 8	Add previous two
Alternating	1, 5, 2, 6, 3, 7	Two series mixed
n^2+1	2, 5, 10, 17	n squared + 1
Power	1, 4, 27, 256	$1^1, 2^2, 3^3, 4^4$

PRACTICE PROBLEMS

Q1: 5, 11, 23, 47, 95, ?

Q2: 1, 1, 2, 3, 5, 8, ?

Q3: 2, 6, 12, 20, 30, ?

Q4: 3, 6, 11, 18, 27, ?

Q5: 1, 4, 27, 256, ?

Answers: Q1: 191 ($x2+1$) | Q2: 13 (Fibonacci) | Q3: 42 (diffs: 4,6,8,10,12) | Q4: 38 (diffs: 3,5,7,9,11) | Q5: 3125 (5^5)

TRICK #5

BLOOD RELATIONS - Drawing Method

Never solve in your head! Draw = 100% accuracy. TCS asks 3-4 questions.

SYMBOL SYSTEM (Use These in Exam Rough Paper!)

Male = Square (box shape)

Female = Circle

Unknown = Triangle

Marriage = Horizontal line connecting two

Parent-Child = Vertical line going down

Siblings = Connected from same parent line above

Relationship Decoder Table (MEMORIZE!):

Relation Chain	Answer	Hindi
Father's/Mother's father	Grandfather	Dada/Nana
Father's/Mother's mother	Grandmother	Dadi/Nani
Father's brother	Uncle	Chacha/Tau
Father's sister	Aunt	Bua
Mother's brother	Uncle	Mama
Mother's sister	Aunt	Mausi
Brother's wife	Sister-in-law	Bhabhi
Sister's husband	Brother-in-law	Jija
Son's wife	Daughter-in-law	Bahu
Daughter's husband	Son-in-law	Damaad
Uncle/Aunt's child	Cousin	Cousin
Brother's son/daughter	Nephew/Niece	Bhatija/Bhatiji

EXAMPLE 1: 'She is my mother's only daughter's daughter.' Who?

Chain: My mother's only daughter = MYSELF (I am the only daughter)

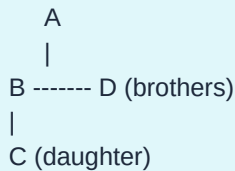
My daughter = the person in question

ANSWER: My Daughter

KEY RULE: 'Only son/daughter of my parent' = MYSELF!

EXAMPLE 2: B is son of A. C is daughter of B. D is brother of B. How is A related to C?

Draw the tree:



A is C's GRANDPARENT (grandfather or grandmother - gender unknown)

EXAMPLE 3: 'His mother is the only daughter of my mother.' Relation?

My mother's only daughter = ME (the speaker)

His mother = ME

ANSWER: The speaker is the MAN'S MOTHER

TIP: Whenever you see 'only' - it simplifies to the speaker themselves!

PRACTICE PROBLEMS

Q1: A's mother is B's sister. How is B related to A?

Q2: P's father's mother's only son = ?

Q3: 'She is my grandfather's only son's daughter' = ?

Q4: X is Y's brother's wife's sister. X to Y?

Q5: 'His mother's father's wife' = ?

Answers: Q1: Uncle/Aunt | Q2: P's father | Q3: My sister/myself | Q4: Sister-in-law | Q5: Grandmother (Nani)

Want Coding-Decoding, Syllogisms & Seating tricks too?

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Plus: Verbal Ability tricks (Grammar + RC + Prepositions)

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TRICK #6

THE 3-PASS STRATEGY - Exam Day Game Plan

This meta-strategy alone can boost your score by 10-15 marks.

PASS 1 - First 60% of Time (Easy Pickings)

Answer ONLY questions you can solve in UNDER 1 minute
SKIP anything that needs more than 1 minute
DO NOT get stuck on any single question
Target: Collect all the 'free' easy marks first
Expected: 45-50 questions answered in this pass

PASS 2 - Next 25% of Time (Medium Difficulty)

Go back to SKIPPED questions
Attempt medium-difficulty ones you can crack in 2 minutes
Use tricks from this PDF for faster solving
Target: 15-20 more questions
Skip truly hard ones for Pass 3

PASS 3 - Last 15% of Time (Smart Guessing)

GUESS all remaining unanswered questions
Use elimination: remove 2 obviously wrong options
Then pick from remaining 2 = 50% chance
NEVER leave any question blank!
Even random guess = 25% chance = FREE marks

Score Comparison:

	Without Strategy	With 3-Pass Strategy
Easy Qs Answered	40 (miss some due to time)	50 (got them all in Pass 1)
Medium Qs Answered	15 (ran out of time)	20 (focused in Pass 2)
Hard Qs	5 (wasted time here)	0 solved, 10 guessed
Blank/Skipped	20 questions = 0 marks	0 blank! All guessed
Estimated Score	~48/80	~60/80

Optimal Time Allocation:

Section	Questions	Time	Easy First (Pass 1)	Hard Last (Pass 2-3)
Numerical	26	40 min	15 Qs in 20 min	8 Qs + 3 guessed
Reasoning	30	50 min	20 Qs in 25 min	7 Qs + 3 guessed
Verbal	24	30 min	16 Qs in 15 min	5 Qs + 3 guessed

Question Priority Map (What to do FIRST):

DO FIRST (Easy Marks)	DO SECOND (Medium)	DO LAST / GUESS
Simple percentages	Complex word problems	Seating arrangements
Number series (+const)	Time-Speed-Distance	Data sufficiency
Basic blood relations	Probability	Complex syllogisms
Coding-decoding	Profit & Loss chains	Long RC passages
Grammar errors	Ages equations	Complex series
Preposition fill-ups	Pipes & cisterns	Arrangement puzzles

YOU LEARNED 6 TRICKS. THERE ARE 24 TOTAL.

This free PDF covered the **most important 6 tricks** to get you started. But TCS Smart Hiring has questions from **18 more topics** that can make or break your score.

TOPIC	TRICKS INCLUDED
Ratio & Proportion	Alligation Cross, Chain Rule, Mixture Problems
Speed & Distance	Average Speed Trap, Train Problems, Relative Speed
Profit & Loss	Successive Discounts, Marked Price, False Weight
Probability & PnC	Card/Dice/Coin, Permutation vs Combination
Ages Problems	Equation Setup, Ratio Method
LCM & HCF	Division Method, Bell Problem, Practical Apps
Direction Sense	Shadow Logic, Pythagoras, Clock Method
Coding-Decoding	5 Types: Shift, Reverse, Number, Symbol, Mirror
Syllogisms	Venn Diagram, Quick Rules Table
Seating Arrangement	Linear + Circular, Constraint Priority
Reading Comprehension	Question-First Method, Speed Scanning
Grammar Rules	15 Most-Tested Rules with Examples
Prepositions	25 Fixed Pairs TCS Loves to Test
Sentence Completion	Context Clue Method, Elimination
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